

SUPERSTORE SALES ANALYTICS REPORT

1.EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The purpose of this report is to analyse the sales performance of "Superstore X". The analyses are to explore several metrics that will identify answers to aid the company on future decision, including the exploration of overall sales and regional performance, product category analysis as well as customer analysis. The report findings are produced through the data set provided and tools such as SQL and Power Bi were implemented to obtain information and produce insights.

2. PROJECT OVERVIEW

Objectives

- Analyze sales performance.
- Identify high performing products
- Examine customer segments
- Evaluate regional performance

Tools & Technologies Used

- PostgreSQL
- SQL
- Power BI
- DAX (Data Analysis Expressions)

3. DASHBOARD OVERVIEW



KPI Cards

The KPI Cards in the dashboard are to illustrate metrics of overall performance from the data. These include Total Sales (\$2.26M), The total number of orders (5K), Total customers at 'Superstore X' (793) and the Average order value (\$459.48).

Sales Trends

The sales trend chart is to display the sales performance by year (2015-2018). The visual enables the reader to determine annual performance with ease.

Category Performance

There are two visual charts within the dashboard that support category performance. The Donut chart illustrates the performance of the overall category sold by 'Superstore X' and this is further supported by a horizontal bar chart which ranks the sub-category based on the total sales figure.

Regional Performance

The regional performance visual assess total sales performance across geographic regions, enabling the high performing as well as underperforming markets to be identified.

Customer Segment

The visual illustrates the total sales contribution based on its customer segments, being Consumer, Corporate and Home office.

4. KEY FINDINGS

Sales Trend Analysis

The data demonstrates an overall increase in total sales from 2015-2018. Total sales increased from approximately \$480k in 2015 to \$722K in 2018. To identify why this happened more information would be required, and this does create a number of questions. Firstly, what did the company do over this period in terms of marketing and expansion? When looking closely at the data provided, Total sales decreased approximately 4.3% between the years of 2015-2016. This however represented the only year on year decline for 'Superstore X' before sales growth rapidly increased in 2017 and 2018.

Regional Performance

Through analysis the West region is the highest performing regarding total sales generating \$710219.77 overall, representing around 31% of total sales. When looking over the 4-year period it was identified that the West achieved the highest total sales each year from 2015-2018. In contrast the South is the lowest performing region with just over half of total sales of the West (\$389151.45). In order to answer as to why this is, further analyses must be performed with new information such as total number of customers for each region as well as accessibility to number of stores in each region.

Customer Segment Analysis

When identifying the highest contributing segment to total sales, the data suggested that the consumer customer accounted for the highest total sales (\$1.15M) which accounts for approximately 50.9% of total sales. The consumer segment was the largest contribution to total sales across the period of 2015-2018. In contrast, Home Office customers contributed the least revenue at \$424.98K.

Product Performance Analysis

Phones generated the highest sales revenue at approximately \$330K, followed closely by Chairs at \$323K, accounting for approximately 29% of total company sales. When delving deeper into analysis it was found that the reasoning behind Phones being the highest generator was a combination of the average product cost as well as the number of orders (4th highest order count). This data suggests strong customer demand within the product lines. In contract Office supplies were the lowest contributor to total sales, however further analyses illustrated this was down to the average cost of products within this category as the top two sub-category orders were in fact Binders and paper (belonging to Office supplies).

5. RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Investment

From the analysis the first recommendation for the company is to invest into marketing and purchasing a higher stock level with the top performing items, this being phones and chairs.

Increasing stock levels presents an opportunity to further improve sales by meeting customer demand more effectively. In addition, an investment in a marketing strategy could also enhance overall sales.

2. Exploration

Superstore X should conduct an investigation into the South Region to gain a greater understanding of why it is underperforming in comparison to the other regions. The data has limitations as it does not contain the number of stores per region or the population of each region.

This lack of information highlights the need for further investigation. Upon exploring the reasoning to explain the underperforming, Superstore X must consider resource distribution.

3. Customer Segment Strategy

Superstore X should implement targeted strategies to increase sales performance in the 'Home Office' and 'Corporate' customer segments as they generated lower sales in comparison to 'Consumer'.

This may include promotional campaigns and personalised offers targeted towards these segments. Strengthening engagement could help diversify revenue streams and reduce overreliance on Consumer customers.

6.CONCLUSION

The analysis of Superstore X sales performance provided valuable insights into the company's overall performance across, segments, regions and products. The findings illustrated strong sales growth across the analysed period, with the highest sales performance being 2018. In addition, Phones and chairs emerged as the highest performing subcategory whilst the West provided largest contribution to total sales.

However, the analysis also highlighted areas that require attention. The South region is considered as underperforming in comparison to other regions, illustrating potential inefficiencies. In addition, the Home Office customer segment presents opportunity for growth through targeted business strategies.

Overall, this project demonstrated how data analytics can support data driven decision making through identifying trends, gaps in performance and opportunities for Superstore X. Meaningful insights were generated through the use of PostgreSQL, Power BI and DAX to support strategic recommendations for improving business performance in the future.